

The (d)evolution of a language?

Is the English language evolving into something else because of the cultural shift towards geek culture?

Whence cometh the tongues thee bespeak? Pillagers from yonder lands – Ireland, France and Scotland – bespoke naught a word of it. Overmany pillagers doth bequeath foreign tongues to their younglings, and commoners doth bastardise the language of lords – “prithee” for “I pray thee”, and such and such.

De olde English, the language of the bard from whence we all quote, alas, was nary a language of the uneasy head that doth wear the crown. All the world's a stage, and all the men and women merely players in games that English warlords doth play. Pillaging and plundering across the world, and bequeathing foreign words to thine, amongst other monstrosities.

From about the Eighteenth century onwards, it spread across the globe, along with the English Navy, and became a second language to most of the world, and a first language to many as well. It picked up words from every continent, including words from here in India. So when you want to own a *bungalow* near a *jungle*, and wear *Khakis* all day and dream of *Blighty*, thank us Indians!

Then the internet came along, and people from all over the world were connected and could chat with one another. English spread even further, because it was now able to penetrate German homes, and Finnish schools – a new invasion of sorts. As expected, geeks the world over soon started modifying English to suit their culture. That's where g33k, l-|4x0r and 1337 come from.

Usenet abbreviations were also popularised, especially when chat applications such as ICQ and IRC gained popularity. IRC actually is responsible for the spread of a lot of the currently used internet lingo. Necessity is the mother of all inventions though, and the 160 character limit of SMSes, when mobile phones took off was the ultimate harbinger of death to the chastity belts of the prim and propah!

A lot of us may not like the way people use internet slang, but v r used 2 it now. Heck, v hv even got CVs 4 jobs @ dgt, 4 writers, tht use dis lang, n den pple ask y v din rply 2 their mails!

neway, d point v r trying 2 mk is dat it dosen't matt'r whether u like it or nt, because dis is vat is happnin 2 us, v r doing away with useless characters, n trying 2 speed tings up. May b the cming gen vil tlk 2 each other liek this, but as long as dey undrstnd each other, who r v 2 judge?

As v hv said before, it may nt b d most preferred form of evolution, bt can v rly call it devolution? If it cmes dwn 2 a matt'r of survival, and it's the g33k culture tht decides whts cool, n wht isnt, den may b dis is hw v wil all tlk sum day. V wil all still undrstnd 1 anothr, n b able 2 cnvrs. If its wht d cultur of d wrld dmands, den it is wht v will gt.

Of course, we can still hope otherwise; I know I will!

editor@thinkdigit.com